

Edward Coke, Henry Hobart, Laurence Tanfield, and the nine Puisne Judges, the King replied by a letter, in which he told them that the reason they assigned with regard to their oaths were very weak, and again desired them not to proceed in the cause until his return to London.

When, soon afterwards, the King came to town, the judges were summoned to his presence, before the council table at Whitehall, June 6, 1616, where his Majesty, like a true Stuart, entered at some length into the matters contained in the judges' letter, declared that he approved neither of its matter nor manner of expression; condemned them for their remissness in suffering counsellors at the bar to deal in impertinent discussions about his prerogative, and told them they ought to have checked such sallies, nor suffered such insolence upon the crown. With regard to their own business, he thought fit to acquaint them, that deferring their discussions and hearings upon necessary reasons, neither delayed nor denied justice: it was rather a pause of necessary prudence, "as it was always proper and adviseable to consult the King when the crown is concerned;" and farther, he told them that it was wide of the case to say, that it was a point of private contest between subject and subject; for the Bishop, who was defendant,